times when we would need to fight, but the important thing was that we would be fighting together. That was the plan.

'Rely on each other when we feel the pressure,' I concluded. 'Enjoy.'

India won the toss and batted and, though we started well when I managed to run out Rohit Sharma with a direct hit from extra cover in the third over of the game, Shikhar Dhawan and Virat Kohli built a partnership that laid the perfect foundation for India to reach 307 for seven in 50 overs.

MS Dhoni's team backed this up with some really disciplined bowling, giving us nothing loose to hit, and some outstanding fielding, executing run-out opportunities and taking catches. We struggled under pressure from the first ball, and were dismissed for 177, outplayed and decisively beaten. I was disappointed, and told the media the defeat was 'almost embarrassing' but we were not going to panic.

I knew we needed a much-improved performance against the West Indies in Sydney. A camera team travelled with us during the tournament, and their video recording of my talk to the squad on the eve of this match makes it possible to provide a word-for-word transcript:

> *I feel it is that time of the tournament when we really need to focus on freeing up a bit. Relax, breathe deeply and have full faith that we are prepared, because that's what I really believe. Yes, we had a bit of fun today. We didn't hit a lot of balls in the last two days. But we are ready and we must trust each other.*
>
> *We have spoken about obstacles in our way. We had a bad loss against India. Guys are writing bad things about us. We've got injuries going on. There will always be obstacles that come your way. That's part of tournaments like this. We are going to have controversial stuff around us all the time. But we can deal with that because we created this culture and we have to look after it, boys.*